

Peer Progress Indicator

Basic Accessibility Review Checklist

1. Text Alternatives

Ensure that users who cannot see images or visual indicators can still understand the information.

Checklist

1. All informative images, charts and icons include meaningful alternative text (alt text).
2. Decorative images are hidden from assistive technologies and do not create unnecessary screen reader output.
3. Icons used to represent progress or status include accessible labels or accompanying text.
4. Complex visual content, such as charts or progress graphics, provides a text summary that communicates the same information.
5. Any status or achievement displayed visually is also available in text format.

2. Colour Contrast

Ensure content is readable for users with low vision or colour vision deficiency.

Checklist

1. Normal text has a minimum colour contrast ratio of 4.5:1 against its background.
2. Large text has a minimum contrast ratio of 3:1.
3. Icons, buttons and other important interface components have sufficient non-text contrast.
4. Colour is never the only way of indicating progress, status, warnings or success.
5. Additional indicators, such as labels, icons or patterns, are used together with colour to communicate information.

3. Labels

Ensure all interactive elements are clearly identified for both visual users and assistive technologies.

Checklist

1. Every button has a clear and descriptive label.
2. Form fields are associated with visible labels.

3. Labels accurately describe the action or information expected.
4. Links clearly describe their destination instead of using generic text such as "Click here".
5. Error messages clearly identify which field requires attention and explain how to fix the problem.

4. Keyboard Use

Ensure the interface can be fully operated without a mouse.

Checklist

1. All interactive elements are accessible using only the keyboard.
2. Users can navigate using the Tab, Shift+Tab, Enter and Space keys where appropriate.
3. Keyboard focus is always visible.
4. The keyboard navigation order follows a logical sequence.
5. No keyboard traps prevent users from leaving a component.
6. All-important actions can be completed without requiring a mouse.

5. Screen Reader Wording

Ensure screen reader users receive clear, meaningful and well-structured information.

Checklist

1. Headings follow a logical hierarchy.
2. Buttons and links have meaningful accessible names.
3. Dynamic status updates are announced appropriately by screen readers.
4. Form controls include accessible descriptions where additional guidance is required.
5. Important information is presented as text rather than only as visual elements.
6. Reading order remains logical when navigating with a screen reader.

Key Finding

The Peer Progress Indicator is likely to rely on visual indicators such as colours, icons and progress graphics. Without appropriate accessibility support, users with colour vision deficiencies, low vision or those using screen readers may not receive the same information. Accessibility should therefore be considered from the beginning of the design process rather than added after implementation.

Recommended Next Step

Before implementing the Peer Progress Indicator, review the interface design against this checklist. After development begins, perform accessibility testing using keyboard-only navigation, a screen reader (such as NVDA or VoiceOver), and colour contrast checking tools to confirm the feature meets WCAG Level AA accessibility requirements.